RipGof.B is an improvement of the former exploit used in GinWui attacks. RipGof.B attacks included improvements to shellcode that attempts to fork to different locations based upon the address value of the stack to exploit multiple versions of Microsoft Word. Once installed, RipGof.B attempts to connect to enjoy.irdet.com and enjoy.bmwsee.com over TCP port 80. It runs as a rootkit and backdoor Trojan horse and phones home to a Chinese server with stolen data.

RipGof malicious code does not exist as a distribution in the underground, leading investigators to look into the original RipGof.A malicious code. Over a year prior to the 2006 targeted attacks RipGof.A emerges in the wild. RipGof.A attempted to exploit the Jet Engine Database exploit in March 2005. This proves attempted exploitation and installation of code through RipGof for a year prior to more sophisticated codes and attacks.

In summary, RipGof and GinWui attacks both use the same private exploit code against Microsoft Word and both install rootkit based codes to steal and send information back to Chinese sources. This circumstantial evidence reveals that Wicked Rose and the NCPH group likely began their exploitation efforts at least a year and a half to two years prior to sophisticated attacks that commenced in 2006. Once the group found a vulnerability within Microsoft Word they were able to improve upon it and their targeted attack techniques to distribute multiple targeted attacks and malicious codes for criminal gain as hackers for hire.

6 Timeline of Events

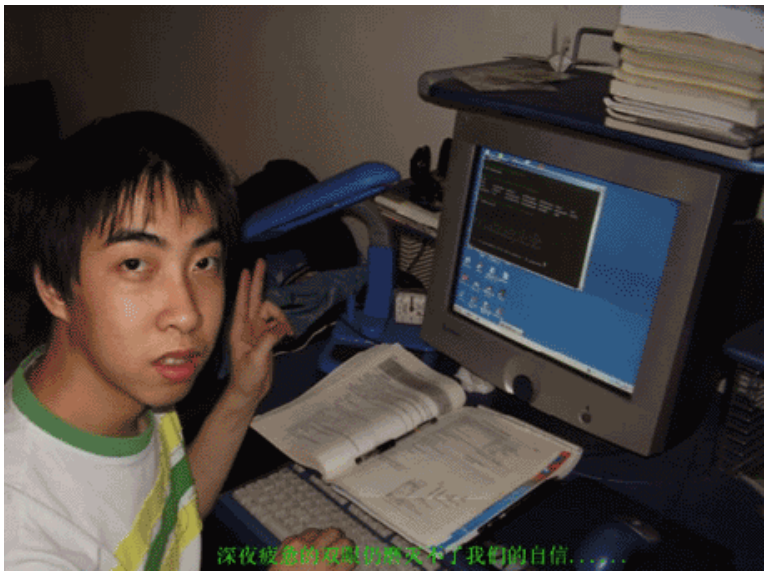
Wicked Rose and the NCPH hacking group are implicated in multiple Office based attacks over a two year period. An attack in 2006 used RipGof.B in the attack. RipGof.A first emerged a year earlier using an exploit that is relatively unsophisticated. Over the next year the Evil Security Team, also out of China, creates the Dasher worm and uses the PcShares Trojan in an attack. Wicked Rose gives a recommendation on the Trojan the day it is updated in the spring of 2006, showing a close affiliation between Wicked Rose and the Evil Security Team actors. Multiple attacks that take place in May and June and later 2006 are related to privately held exploit code for both Microsoft Word and Excel, proven to be developed by Wicked Rose. A timeline of proven associated events related to Wicked Rose attacks is below:

April 22, 2005 - RipGof.A JetEngine DB Attack
Dec. 19, 2005 – Dasher worm and PcShare Trojan attack by Evil Security Team
April 27, 2006 Update to windowsupdates.net attack site
April 30, 2006 - Wicked Rose Drops out of School
May 2, 2006 – 3.0beta3 NCPH remote control (GinWui) public release
May 12, 2006 - Initial probing and GinWui.A exploitation attempts against US target
May 15, 2006 - PcShare Trojan update recommended by Wicked Rose on day of new release
May 16, 2006 - Update to windowsupdates.net attack site
May 16, 2006 - Multiple GinWui.A attacks against US target
May 18, 2006 - SANS reports zero-day attack
May 19, 2006 Update to windowsupdates.net attack site
May 20, 2006 - GinWui.B Attack
May 20, 2006 - WZT Kicked out of NCPH
May 29, 2006 - GinWui.C Attack
June 1, 2006 Update to windowsupdates.net attack site
June 9, 2006 – Mdropper.F Attack
June 14, 2006 – Daserf.A Attack
June 15, 2006 – Mdropper.G Attack

June 15, 2006 – Booli.A Trojan Attack
June 16, 2006 - Flux.E Attack
June 18, 2006 - RipGof.B Attack
June 23, 2006 – PPDropper.A
June 23, 2006 – Booli.B Trojan attack
June 25, 2006 - GinWui.D Attack
June 26, 2006 - GinWui.E Attack
Sept. 27, 2006 – PPDropper.F Attack
Sept. 30, 2006 – GinWui.G Attack
Oct. 9, 2006 – Wicked Rose reports pay increase; likely in September

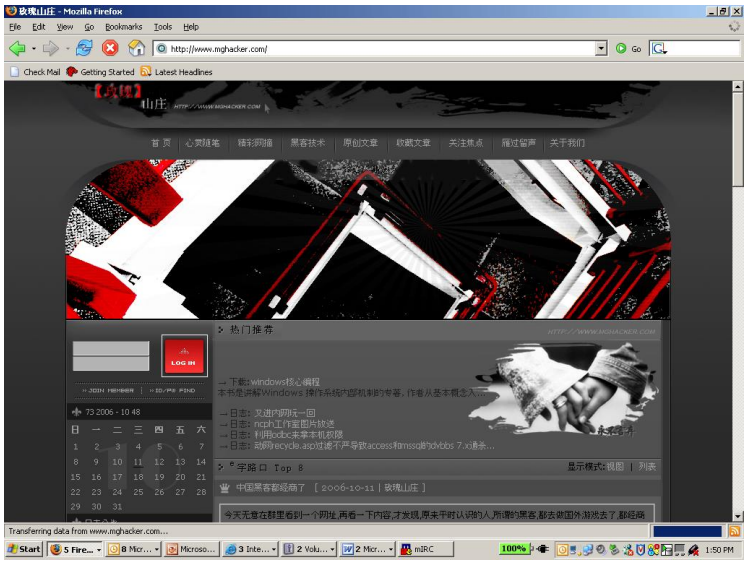
7 A Pictorial Introduction to Wicked Rose and NCPH

Just who are Wicked Rose and the NCPH hacker group? As it turns out, a collection of college students in China who likely room with one another and regularly support their hacking interests. In-depth research implicates Wicked Rose as the ring-leader of the group, responsible for managing hacker for hire relationships and paying group members for their work as hackers. During the time of targeted attacks in 2006 their income increased significantly, to full-time wages for part time hacking. Wicked Rose, leader of the group, is pictured below:



玫瑰 黑客 (MeiGui HeiKe) **"Rose Hacker"**
QQ number is 5372453 ***www.mghacker.com***

Wicked Rose maintains a personal site at www.mghacker.com.



Wicked Rose's Website: www.mghacker.com

Rose is an approximate 20-year-old (2006) student at the Sichuan University of Science & Engineering. In the spring of 2006 Wicked Rose claims to have dropped out of school for full time hacking opportunities. Specifically, on April 30, 2006 his blog entry claims he did not register for his university exam. He performed significant updates to his rootkit code from March through June 2006. He later returned to school by September 2006.

Wicked Rose claims responsibility on his blog for targeted e-mail based attacks containing Microsoft Word and CHM exploits from the spring of 2006.

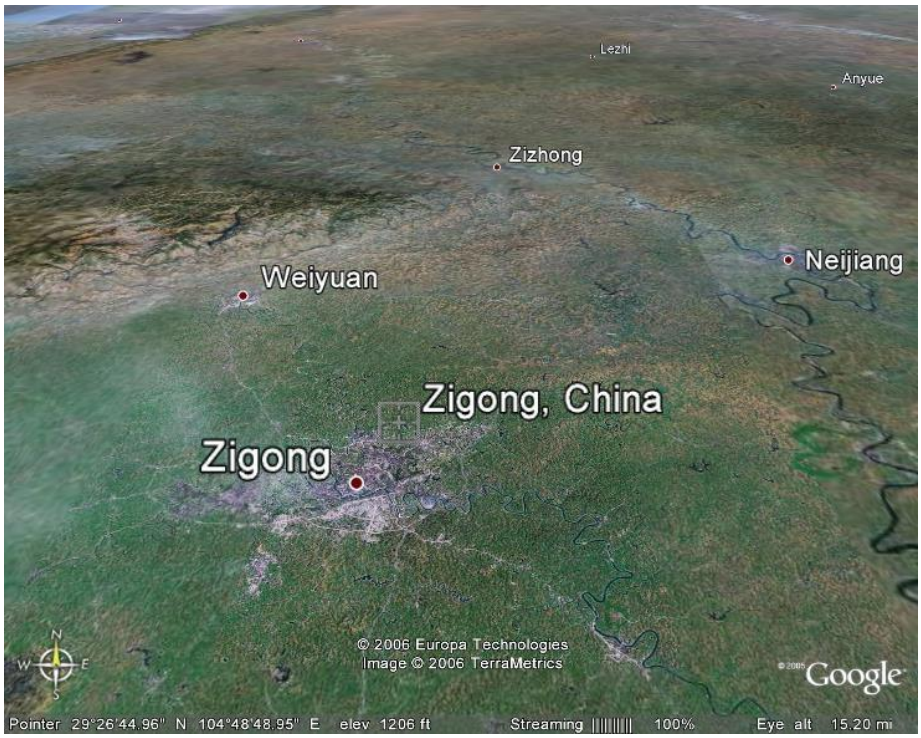
Other NCPH-member websites include: http://rodag.blogbus.com, http://www.cppblog.com/charles and http://kungbim.blogbus.com. The main NCPH website is www.ncph.net:

NCPH Studio website www.ncph.net

Registration information for ncph.net reveals a Chinese registrant:

Registrant Contact: ncph studio (ncph2005@126.com) si chuan li gong xue yuan zigong, Sichuan, cn 643000 P: +86.13154663992 F: +86.13154663992

The main location of the NCPH group is in Zigong, Sichuan Province, in south-central China.

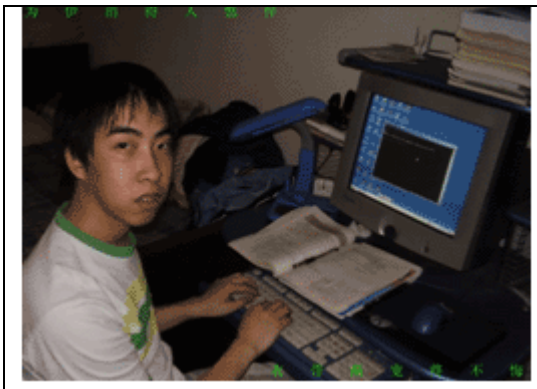


Zigong, Sichuan Province, in south-central China

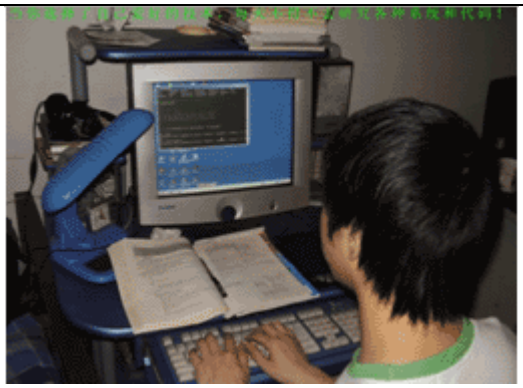
The NCPH group (NCPH Studio) in Zigong, China, is shown here:

NCPH hackers at work in the "ncph studio"
Left to right: "Wicked Rose," KuNgBiM, Charles and Rodag

Additional photos featuring Wicked Rose and NCPH hackers are below, captured from their various websites and blog entries in 2006. Chinese translation for each photo are below:



"Wicked Rose"
From an ancient Chinese poem, expressing the devotion of his heart for hacking.

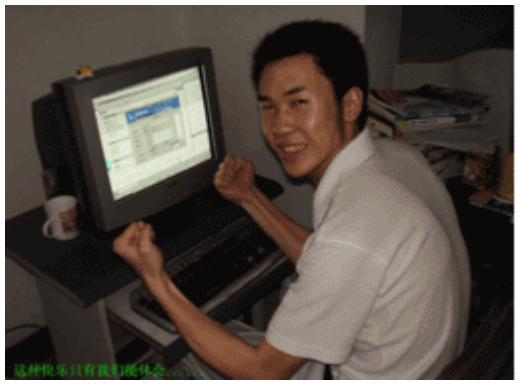


"After you choose the technology you love, you have to research every system and code everyday!"

Charles: "Silence belongs to our world..."

Charles
"Charles always laughs so brightly when searching for program problems!"

Ronag
"Behind every successful design, he always has a slight smile…"



KuNgBiM
"Only we can feel this kind of happy..."

Wicked Rose and NCPH hacking photos

WHG ("Fig")